

Regarding the attack against Colombian presidential pre-candidate Miguel Uribe Turbay

Youth of the Centrist Democrat International (YCDI)

The Youth of the Centrist Democrat International (YCDI) strongly condemns the attack that took place today against Senator and presidential pre-candidate Miguel Uribe Turbay in Colombia. This violent act is not only a direct threat to his life and integrity, but also a grave assault on democracy and political freedom in the country.

We express our full solidarity with Miguel Uribe, his family and his team. We call on the Colombian authorities to conduct a prompt, thorough and transparent investigation that leads to the identification and prosecution of both the material and the intellectual perpetrators of this crime.

We categorically reject all forms of political violence and, in particular, the expressions of hatred that have been encouraged from the highest levels of power. President Gustavo Petro has repeatedly used inflammatory language, labelling the opposition as “Nazis”, “paramilitaries” and “murderers”, among other terms that are unacceptable in a democratic context. Such rhetoric, far from fostering a plural and constructive political debate, deepens division and has already led to serious incidents of violence and political persecution.

This conduct is unworthy of a Head of State. A true democratic leader must guarantee the right to life, respect and free participation of all citizens, regardless of their political ideology or affiliation.

The YCDI reaffirms its support for the strengthening of democratic institutions in Colombia and its commitment to the defence of human rights, freedom of expression and respect for political differences as fundamental pillars of a truly free and just society.

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